GRADE 4

Curriculum Book

Businesses need a simple plan

Five questions, one page, one plan. Make the idea move.

ABOUT THIS BOOK

Grade 4 - Curriculum Book

Five questions, one page, one plan. Make the idea move. This book is part of the Cash to Company K-12 program - a financial literacy and entrepreneurship curriculum aligned to Jump$tart, CEE, CCSS, C3, and CASEL standards.

Year theme: *Businesses need a simple plan* ***Grade band:*** *3-5 (upper elementary, bridge year)* ***Total instructional time:*** *~36 weeks · 60–90 minutes per week* ***Anchor mascot:*** *Cash, the program's animated host*

Five answers, one page

The whole plan fits on one sheet of paper.

Why this year

"A plan is just five honest answers in a row. Start with one."

- CASH, GRADE 4

Nine- and ten-year-olds are at the bridge. Last year, in Grade 3, they noticed that business ideas come from skills they already have, hobbies they already love, and needs they can already see. They got their first taste of the cost-revenue-profit math. They named ideas and drew logos. The work was real, but it was small.

Grade 4 is where the work gets a frame around it. The frame is a plan. Not a thirty-page document. Not a "business plan" the way an adult MBA writes one. A one-page plan a fourth grader can hold in one hand. An idea, a customer, a price, a list of what it costs, and a simple guess at what's left over. That's the year.

The reason a plan matters at this age is not because plans are sacred. It's because a plan turns the question "what would happen?" into "let's check." A student who has filled out a one-page plan for a backyard car-wash business can spot the moment when their math doesn't work. A student who hasn't can't. Plans aren't magic; they're just a way of writing your thinking down where you can see it. Once you can see it, you can fix it.

The other reason: Grade 4 is the first year the program asks students to budget. We give them a real cap — fifty dollars — for a real classroom event, with at least four categories. They have to live inside that number. They will overrun the cap on Draft 1. They will trim something. They will ask the question every adult who has ever managed a budget has asked: *what matters more?* That is the start of financial decision-making, and the standards we cite at the end of this book name it explicitly.

Cash's voice this year is plainer than last year's. Sentences are 10 to 15 words. Vocabulary is *customer, problem, plan, profit*. Cash asks: "*You picked this idea. How do you know somebody actually wants it?*" That sentence is the year's spine.

The big ideas (Understanding by Design — Stage 1)

> TRY THIS
>
> **One question, five people**
>
> Pick the customer question from your one-page plan. Ask five real people in one day. Write each answer in one sentence.

These are the full-sentence understandings the year is built around. Every unit, every lesson, and every assessment can be traced back to one or more of these.

1. **A plan is just thinking written down.** When you write your idea on a page, you can spot what's missing. You can't fix an idea that lives only in your head.
2. **A customer is a real person, not "everybody."** "Everyone in school" is not a customer. "Third graders who get hungry between recess and lunch" is.
3. **Money in must come from somewhere; money out goes somewhere.** Every dollar of revenue is a dollar a real customer chose to give you. Every dollar of cost is a dollar you paid for something specific.
4. **A budget is a promise to yourself about a number.** When you set a $50 cap and you spend $63, you broke the promise. The fix is not to feel bad. The fix is to cut something.
5. **Plans change. That's not failing.** A "before" and "after" plan with three honest changes is a better plan than one that pretended to be perfect on Day 1.

Essential questions (returned to all year)

WORDS TO KNOW

Plan
Five honest answers about how a business works.

Customer
The exact person you can name and describe.

Offer
What the customer gets, in plain words.

Pricing
What the customer pays, and why that number.

Test
The smallest real thing you can do to see if the plan works.

- Who, exactly, is this for? How would I know if I picked the wrong customer?
- How much will it cost me to run this for one customer? For ten?
- What's left over after I cover my costs?
- If I had only $50, what would I cut?
- What did I think on Day 1 that turned out to be wrong?

Year-at-a-glance

MATH MOMENT

How many a week?

If you sold 3 a day for 5 days, how many is that? If each one costs $2 to make and sells for $5, what's left?

The year is built as four units. Each unit ends with a public-facing artifact and ties into the rolling Capstone — the *One-Page Plan* — that students sharpen across the year.

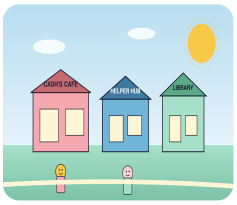
UNIT	WEEKS	TITLE	BIG IDEA	ANCHOR ARTIFACT (CAPSTONE CHECKPOINT)
1	1–8	Read a real business	Real businesses do real things for real people.	A 3–5 sentence written profile of a real local business: what it does, who it helps, how it makes money.
2	9–18	The Reality Check	An idea is just a guess until you check it with five questions.	A completed 5-question Reality Check on the student's chosen idea, with reasonable estimates and one customer statement.
3	19–28	The $50 Plan	A budget is a promise about a number.	A one-page event budget under a $50 cap, with at least 4 categories, subtotals, and a written choice the student had to make.
4	29–36	The One-Page Plan defense	A plan is thinking written down — and then revised.	A one-page business plan + a "before/after" diff sheet showing 3 specific revisions, defended in a 4-minute peer panel.

The Capstone — the One-Page Plan defense — is the Unit 4 artifact and the year's culminating performance. By the end of Unit 1 students have studied a real business; by Unit 2 they have an idea and a customer; by Unit 3 they have a budget; by Unit 4 they have written, revised, and defended the plan. Each unit's artifact feeds the next.

Vocabulary roadmap (15–20 terms)

CASH ASKS

"*What did they actually say? Tell me one real sentence.*"



PEOPLE YOU CAN ASK

Five real answers

Read each plan answer to a different person. Write what they say back, exactly. That's data.

Vocabulary is layered across the year. Each unit introduces 4–6 new terms. Old terms recycle. Students keep a Vocabulary Spine in the back of their Capstone Journal.

Unit 1 (real-business vocabulary): *business, customer, product, service, profile, summary.*

Unit 2 (Reality Check vocabulary): *idea, plan, estimate, reasonable, customer statement, problem.*

Unit 3 (budget vocabulary): *budget, cap, category, subtotal, total, cost, revenue, profit.*

Unit 4 (revision vocabulary): *draft, revise, change, before/after, agenda, blocker, defend.*

Total: 18 terms across the year. The Frayer model is built once for *plan*, *customer*, *budget*, and *profit* — the four "weight-bearing" terms. The other terms are introduced in context, with a one-sentence definition on the Vocabulary Spine page.

Standards alignment (this year centers six benchmarks)

FAMILY TALK

Five honest answers

Read your one-page plan to a family member. Ask: 'Which answer sounds the least real to you, and why?' Listen, don't defend.

- **Jump$tart Standard 1 (Spending and Saving), Benchmark 4-3:** Outline a plan for buying a needed or wanted item — extended at G4 to a small business plan.
- **Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 4-3:** Apply the steps of a decision-making process.
- **CEE Standard 2 (Buying Goods and Services), Grade 4:** Planning for spending can help people make informed choices.
- **CCSS-Math 4.OA.A.3:** Solve multistep word problems with whole numbers — used in the 5-question Reality Check.
- **CCSS-Math 4.MD.A.2:** Use the four operations to solve word problems involving distances, intervals of time, money — used in event budgeting under a cap.
- **CCSS-ELA W.4.4:** Produce clear and coherent writing — 1-sentence customer statement, 1-page plan.
- **NGSS-ETS 3-5-ETS1-2:** Generate and compare multiple possible solutions to a problem.
- **C3 D2.Eco.4.3-5:** Explain why incentives vary between buyers and sellers.

The eight strand outcomes (verbatim, all addressed this year)

CASH ASKS

"*Five ideas beats one idea. Pick the most real-sounding one.*"

The year's lessons collectively meet all eight strand outcomes from the Master Scope and Sequence:

- **BAVC.** I can read or watch a short business profile and summarize what the business does, who it helps, and how it makes money in 3–5 sentences.
- **PSIG.** I can take an idea and run it through a 5-question "Reality Check" (Who buys? How much? How many? What does it cost me? What's left?) and write reasonable estimates.
- **MFL.** I can fill in a 1-page budget for a small classroom event with at least 4 categories that does not exceed a $50 cap, showing all subtotals.
- **CBM.** I can write a 1-sentence "this is for ___ who needs ___" customer statement for my business idea.
- **OSO.** I can build a 1-page business plan template (idea, customer, price, costs, plan) and complete it for one idea.
- **LTO.** I can run a 5-minute team meeting using a 3-item agenda (last week, this week, blockers) with my role assigned.
- **ESL.** I can list 3 rules a kid-run business should follow (honesty about ingredients, safety with food, asking adult permission, age limits on labor) and pick the most important one with a reason.
- **LRCI.** I can compare a "before" and "after" version of my plan and circle three changes I made and why.

Lessons that center each strand are flagged in the Lesson Plans book.

Anchor texts

A mix of short readings, video, and case studies. None require purchase; school-friendly substitutes are provided where possible.

- *Lemonade in Winter* (Emily Jenkins, Paul O. Zelinsky) — picture book about two siblings running a lemonade stand in cold weather; carries the cost/revenue/profit story without lecturing.
- A 1-page printed profile of a real local business (suggested: a neighborhood bakery, a barbershop, a tutoring center). Provided in program assets; teachers may substitute one local to their school.
- *Beatrice's Goat* (Page McBrier) — a girl in Uganda whose family receives a goat that becomes a tiny business. Use for the "real customer" lesson; pairs well with the Day 1 / Reality Check arc.
- One short kid-friendly founder origin story (suggested: a 2-minute YouTube clip about Cory Nieves, the kid behind Mr. Cory's Cookies). Public domain or fair-use clip, swap as needed.
- One Cash video per unit (8 across the year — see the Video Scripts file).
- Two side-by-side product labels (one clear and honest, one vague) for the Unit 4 ethics check. Provided in the program assets.

Project arc — the One-Page Plan (Capstone)

CASH SAYS

"*First tries get something wrong. The fix is what makes you a real entrepreneur.*"

Across the year, each student develops one Capstone idea. The idea can be a real business, a service, a classroom event, or a fundraiser. The Capstone has four checkpoints, one per unit:

- **End of Unit 1 (Week 8):** Real-Business Profile — the student writes a 3–5 sentence summary of a real local business, then drafts a one-sentence "kind of business I'm curious about" for their own Capstone.
- **End of Unit 2 (Week 18):** Reality Check Pack — the 5-question Reality Check fully filled in, plus the one-sentence customer statement.
- **End of Unit 3 (Week 28):** $50 Budget — a one-page budget for a hypothetical event tied to the Capstone idea, under a $50 cap, with subtotals.
- **End of Unit 4 (Week 36):** One-Page Plan + Defense — the full one-page plan, the before/after revision diff, and a 4-minute defense in front of a peer panel.

Optional pivot windows in Weeks 9 and 19 let students switch ideas if their Reality Check told them the first one wouldn't work. Pivoting is reframed as evidence-driven, not as failing.

Assessment philosophy

We assess two things at every checkpoint:

1. **Did the student do the work the standard names?** (Did they actually fill in 4 budget categories? Did they actually estimate "how many" with a number?)
2. **Did the student think about it?** (Can they explain why they picked that customer? Can they say what changed between Draft 1 and Draft 2?)

The 4-point rubrics in the Rubric Bank are the spine. At Grade 4 we use:

- **Rubric 1 (Business Plan)** at the simplified Grade 4–5 setting (4 criteria: Customer clarity, Value proposition, Financial logic, Communication).

- **Rubric 3 (Budget)** at the simplified Grade 4 setting (4 criteria: Mathematical accuracy, Realism of inputs, Category completeness, "Budget is neat and labeled").
- **Rubric 4 (Customer Research)** at the Grades 4–6 setting (first 3 criteria only: Quality of evidence, Specificity, Problem statement). At G4 we expect 1–2 short interviews or surveys for "evidence."
- **Rubric 5 (Reflection Writing)** at the 3–5 setting (first 3 criteria only). 3–5 sentence reflections are acceptable form.

Holistic scoring is allowed for Cash-video reflections and quick exit tickets. Analytic scoring is required for the four Capstone checkpoints.

Differentiation in Grade 4

- **ELL.** Sentence frames are provided for every written artifact. Cognates are flagged where they exist (Spanish: *plan*, *cliente*, *presupuesto* / budget, *ganancia* / profit). Allow native-language brainstorming with English finalization on the artifact. Pair students with strong English speakers for partner share-outs.
- **IEP/504.** Provide pre-formatted templates with section labels and example numbers. Allow voice-recorded answers transcribed later. Calculator is allowed throughout the budget unit. Reduce the budget category count from 4 to 3 if the student is overwhelmed; build the 4th in conferring time.
- **Advanced learners.** Push for specificity ("third graders who play kickball," not "kids"). Add a second customer statement for a different segment. In the budget unit, add a "what if my cap is $40 instead of $50" sensitivity question. In the Capstone, add a "what could go wrong" section identifying one real risk.

Sensitivity considerations specific to this year

- **Family money is off-limits.** Never ask "how much does your family spend on…" or "does your family budget?" The $50 cap is hypothetical and classroom-bound. The Reality Check uses *for a sample customer*, not *for your family*.
- **Real local businesses.** When students profile a local business, they may name a family business (a parent's, an uncle's). That is fine; coach toward "what does this business do for customers" and away from "how much does your family make from it."
- **Pricing fairness.** Students at this age may want to charge $20 for a cookie. Treat pricing as a real choice with consequences, not a moral question. Cash's frame: "*That's a choice. What do you think will happen at that price?*"
- **Sensitivity flag for the Unit 3 budget unit.** Some students live in food-insecure households. A "snack budget" event prompt may surface that. Use the *classroom event* framing (a school-wide game day, a craft afternoon) — not a meal — and offer an alternative event topic (a class craft, a class read-aloud) to any student who flags discomfort. This is the year's at-minimum sensitivity flag.

Materials and tools (year)

- A Capstone Journal (composition notebook, paper or digital).
- The Grade 4 Student Activity Book.
- The Real-Business Profile template (provided).
- The 5-Question Reality Check template (provided).
- The $50 Event Budget template (provided).
- The One-Page Plan template (provided).
- The Before/After Revision Diff template (provided).
- A 3-item meeting agenda template (Last week / This week / Blockers).

- Three highlighter colors (yellow, blue, pink) — used in Unit 4 for revision marking.
- One Cash short video per unit (8 across the year).
- Optional: a spreadsheet tool (Google Sheets, Excel, or paper). Not required; the budget can be done by hand on the printed template.

How this year hooks into the rest of Cash to Company

- **Reaches back to Grade 3** — students who came through Grade 3 already named business ideas from skills, hobbies, and needs. They drew a logo. They computed a simple cost/revenue/profit on a lemonade stand. Grade 4 takes those raw ingredients and surrounds them with a frame. The Skills + Hobbies + Needs web from Grade 3 is allowed (and encouraged) as the Day 1 idea pool.
- **Reaches forward to Grade 5** — Grade 5 builds on the budget with margin-based pricing and on the customer statement with a 30-second elevator pitch. Strong Grade 4 work — especially a sharp customer statement and a clean budget — makes Grade 5 dramatically easier. The Grade 5 Market Day Capstone is, in effect, "what happens when the Grade 4 plan meets reality."
- **Vertical strands.** The eight strands continue from Grade 3 outcomes through Grade 5. Grade 4 sits in the middle. The MFL strand grows from Grade 3's whole-number profit to Grade 4's event budget under a cap to Grade 5's pricing-with-margin. The OSO strand grows from Grade 3's "run-of-day list" to Grade 4's "1-page plan template" to Grade 5's "inventory tracker." Same spine, more weight each year.

A note to first-time teachers of this curriculum

You don't need to be an entrepreneur to teach this. You don't need to be good at math. You need to be willing to ask one question, every time a student says something vague: "*How do you know?*" That's it. That's the

move. When a student says "kids will love it," ask "which kids, and how do you know?" When a student says "we'll make a lot of money," ask "how much, and how did you figure?" By Week 12, the students will start asking each other.

The Cash videos take pressure off introducing concepts. The lesson plans take pressure off pacing. The rubrics take pressure off grading. Your job is to enforce the year's norm: thinking has to be specific, and a plan has to have real numbers in it. A fourth grader who finishes this year with a one-page plan that holds together — even if the plan is for a tiny business that never gets built — is a fourth grader who will be a clearer thinker about money and ideas for a long time. That is the only promise.

Senior expert upgrade pack — Grade 4

Multi-class branching scenario — "The Spring Carnival snack station"

A 3-day branching scenario for Unit 3 (the $50 plan).

- **Day 1.** Read aloud: "*The school is throwing a Spring Carnival. Your team is in charge of the snack station. You have $50 total. There are three options.*"
- **Option A — Popcorn.** $20 popcorn machine rental + $15 supplies = $35. Sell 100 bags at $1 = $100 revenue. Profit = $65.
- **Option B — Cookies.** Pre-made cookies bought wholesale: $30 for 60 cookies. Sell at $1.50 each = $90 revenue. Profit = $60.
- **Option C — Lemonade + cookies.** Lemonade supplies: $15. Cookies: $20 wholesale (40 cookies). Sell lemonade at $1, cookies at $1.50: 40 cookies × $1.50 = $60 + 30 lemonades × $1 = $30. Total revenue: $90. Profit = $55.

Class question: Which option does your team pick? Each trio picks one and writes one paragraph defending it. Defense must include the budget and the profit estimate.

- **Day 2.** Trios present their option. Class votes. Then the teacher reveals the surprise: "*Two days before the Carnival, the popcorn machine breaks. What does Option A do?*" Trios re-plan. Some pivot to Option B; some keep popcorn but cut to a smaller version.
- **Day 3.** Final budget revisions. Each trio submits a one-page event budget under $50 with at least 4 categories. Class compares budgets.

This scenario practices BAVC, MFL (event budget), OSO (1-page plan), LRCI (revising under uncertainty). Repeatable with: a school book sale, a class party, a fundraising bake stand.

Cross-grade bridge — preview to Grade 5

End of year, mention to families: "*Next year, your child will take this kind of plan and put a real price on the items. Grade 4 builds the plan; Grade 5 picks the price and tests it on Market Day.*"

ROUND 2 PATCH — Standards Citations (verbatim)

- **Jump$tart Standard 1 (Spending and Saving), Benchmark 4-3:** "Outline a plan for buying a needed or wanted item" — extended at G4 to a small business plan.
- **Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 4-3:** "Apply the steps of a decision-making process."
- **CEE Standard 2 (Buying Goods and Services), Grade 4:** "Planning for spending can help people make informed choices."
- **CCSS-Math 4.OA.A.3:** "Solve multistep word problems with whole numbers" — used in the 5-question Reality Check.

- **CCSS-Math 4.MD.A.2:** "Use the four operations to solve word problems involving distances, intervals of time, money" — used in event budgeting under a cap.
- **CCSS-ELA W.4.4:** "Produce clear and coherent writing" — 1-sentence customer statement, 1-page plan.
- **NGSS-ETS 3-5-ETS1-2:** "Generate and compare multiple possible solutions to a problem."
- **C3 D2.Eco.4.3-5:** "Explain why incentives vary between buyers and sellers."

ROUND 2 PATCH — Strand Outcomes (verbatim)

By end of Grade 4, a student can: - **BAVC:** "I can read or watch a short business profile and summarize what the business does, who it helps, and how it makes money in 3–5 sentences." - **PSIG:** "I can take an idea and run it through a 5-question Reality Check (Who buys? How much? How many? What does it cost me? Whats left?) and write reasonable estimates." - **MFL:** "I can fill in a 1-page budget for a small classroom event with at least 4 categories that does not exceed a $50 cap, showing all subtotals." - **CBM:** "I can write a 1-sentence this is for ___ who needs ___ customer statement for my business idea." - **OSO:** "I can build a 1-page business plan template (idea, customer, price, costs, plan) and complete it for one idea." - **LTO:** "I can run a 5-minute team meeting using a 3-item agenda (last week, this week, blockers) with my role assigned." - **ESL:** "I can list 3 rules a kid-run business should follow (honesty about ingredients, safety with food, asking adult permission, age limits on labor) and pick the most important one with a reason." - **LRCI:** "I can compare a before and after version of my plan and circle three changes I made and why."

ROUND 2 PATCH — Advanced-Learner Specifics (Grade 4)

- **Reality Check extension:** Add a 6th question — "What could go wrong, and what would I do?" Seed of Grade 10 premortem.
- **Budget extension:** Add a *contingency* line item — 5% set aside for surprises. Seed of Grade 11 cash flow buffer.
- **Customer statement extension:** Write *two* customer statements for the same idea, targeting two different customers. Discuss which is more specific and why.
- **5-minute meeting extension:** Be the *minute taker* — write down the agenda, decisions, and one action item per person. Seed of Grade 7 huddle leadership.

FROM CASH

A plan is five honest answers

Who is it for? What is it? Why now? How much? How will I know it worked? Five lines. One page. Done.

KEEP IT REAL

Real customers. Real money. Real lessons.

Every page in this book points back to one habit: ask a real person, listen to the real answer, count the real numbers. The rest is decoration.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

What Grade 4 hits

This curriculum book aligns to the following K-12 standards. See the *Master Standards Alignment Map* for the full grade-band crosswalk.

Jump$tart 3-5
Income - earning, planning, and tradeoffs.

CEE NS5
Roles of producers, consumers, and decisions.

CCSS-MATH 4.OA
Operations and algebraic thinking - model word problems.

CCSS-ELA W.4.2
Write to inform and explain - one-page plan.

CASEL Responsible Decision-Making
Identify problems, analyze situations.

C3 D2.Eco.2.3-5
Identify positive and negative incentives.

FROM CASH

One last thing

"*A plan is just five honest answers in a row. Start with one.*"

- CASH, GRADE 4

A plan is just five honest answers in a row. Start with one. — Cash

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